Koa Shen

B.S. Candidate in Mechanical Engineering | UC Santa Barbara

koashensf@gmail.com (415) 810-8344 koashen.com San Francisco Bay Area / Santa Barbara, CA

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Supplier Development Hiring Team
SpaceX

Re: Summer 2027 Supplier Development Engineering Internship

Dear SpaceX Supplier Development Hiring Team,

I am a mechanical engineering student at UC Santa Barbara, graduating in June 2028, and am excited to be considered for a Summer 2027 Supplier Development Engineering Internship at SpaceX. I am drawn to work that connects design intent with the realities of manufacturing: helping suppliers produce complex hardware consistently, detecting process variation early, and solving problems at their source.

With UCSB Gaucho Racing, I CNC-machine 4130 steel and 7075-T6 aluminum suspension components and work with designers to account for tolerances and manufacturability. I have machined 33 parts and held critical bearing fits within 0.0005 inch, using inspection to confirm that parts meet their functional requirements. When a subtle fault in our shop's CNC lathe put our GR26 spindles at risk, it made the importance of reliable equipment, process monitoring, and timely intervention especially tangible to me.

At SLAC National Accelerator Laboratory, I produce Siemens Solid Edge designs and PDM-controlled drawings with GD&T for manufacture and inspection. I also build mechanical models and check load cases for sensitive instrumentation, which has strengthened my habit of tracing requirements through design, fabrication, and verification. At the Exploratorium, manual machining and maintaining public-facing exhibits taught me to value practical, serviceable solutions and clear documentation that supports the people who build and maintain hardware.

My recent conversation with the SpaceX team deepened my interest in supplier development. I especially enjoyed discussing how to establish confidence in a critical tube feature across a 100,000-part production run, including measurement strategy, statistical analysis, and changes in measurement accuracy over time. I would bring hands-on manufacturing experience, careful attention to quality, and a genuine interest in working collaboratively with suppliers to resolve technical issues.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would be grateful for the opportunity to contribute to SpaceX and learn from a team setting demanding standards for production hardware.

Sincerely,
Koa Shen